FROM	Robert Samuel White
TO	[Tugman Volunteer Services Lead]
DATE	February 7, 2025, 1:19 PM PT
SUBJECT	**Re: September**
DOCUMENT	01JKH4FW385EVEHYH5HMS0G7V5

Thanks [Tugman Volunteer Services Lead]! I'll see you in April!

From: [Tugman Volunteer Services Lead]
Sent: Friday, February 7, 2025 12:56:09 PM
To: Robert Samuel White <rsw@rswfire.com>
Subject: Re: September

Hi Sam, that’s alright! Canceling well in advance doesn’t cause any problems. Everyone understands that things come up!

From: Robert Samuel White <rsw@rswfire.com>
Sent: Thursday, February 6, 2025 11:59:24 PM
To: [Tugman Volunteer Services Lead]
Subject: Re: September

If this would hurt me in any way, I will stay. I just want to be perfectly clear about that. I bring it up now because I'm planning my movements and there are seven months before this assignment, so I trust I wouldn't inconvenience you - the timing, like everything, is a variable in my contemplations. I would stay, joyfully, not as a concession, as total acceptance of alignment. I make this plea because I don't have assignments for July and August but that time is too short for me to go to Kentucky and back, and I couldn't go after September because our parks close for the winter. I just don't see a clear way to make this puzzle work - but staying is one way, and perhaps going to Kentucky in the spring. After April, when I finish at Honeyman that season. I hope you see I'm trying here. I will stay if breaking my commitment would cause disharmony.

From: Robert Samuel White
Sent: Thursday, February 6, 2025 7:15:49 PM
To: [Tugman Volunteer Services Lead]
Subject: September

Hi, [Tugman Volunteer Services Lead].

I have a predicament.

On one hand, I want to establish a reliable relationship with you. I want you to know I'm dependable and you can count on me. This is really important to me.

On the other hand, I really need to go home to Kentucky at some point. It is very likely the last time I will ever see my mother. This is really important to me too.

I was going to go this summer, but I couldn't turn down the Humbug position. Not only is it my favorite place on earth (literally), I get to experience it with the bustling summer activity of the coast!

And I was looking forward to the same kind of experience at Tugman in September, when the park is likely quite busy and active and I'd be responsible for greeting new visitors as relief host.

I really can't tell you how much it meant to me you extended the offer to me and I want more than anything to do it. But I have a problem...

I started making plans to go home this winter and remembered why I came to Oregon in the first place: winters are harsh in Kentucky and the parks are closed. I literally can't travel there then.

After Umpqua in April, I spend two months at Humbug. I'd like to go home after that. But this means backing out of my September assignment at Tugman.

I know that you would accept this. But I need more than that from you. I need to know you understand how torn I feel about it and that it's not a reflection of my future reliability or passion for working with you at your parks. And I need to know this won't hurt me - as you know I already backed out of the very dumb decision to go to a day use area away from the coast, and I have no idea how that information appears in your systems.

I'm trying to build a new life here, but my old life has some loose ends I need to confront. Can you help me?

Sam